

Fuelled by OSS, redBus Gets Onto the Expressway

For companies contemplating OSS to run their operations, here's a case study that should convince them about the merits of the open source-based business model. redBus relies heavily on OSS for its ticketing business and all its systems deploy Linux.



Satish Gidugu, chief technology officer, redBus

Today, in India, small- and medium-sized businesses, too, are increasingly opting for open source technology. redBus is a company that deploys open source technology extensively. Right from the software for its tour and travel agents to the operations within its campus, the company prefers to use open source software (OSS) for most of its work. redBus is in the business of ticketing. And one of the most visible channels through which it offers tickets to its customers is its website, redbus.in. This is for customers who want to avail the online payment option and have Internet access. Customers can also book their services via mobile websites that are configured for the iPhone, BlackBerry, as well as Nokia and Android phones. The company is also building mobile apps to facilitate easier transactions for its customers. Apart from these B2C channels, the company also

has some B2B channels to expand its business. Satish Gidugu, chief technology officer, redBus, elaborates, "We have an aggregate inventory of about 800 tour and travel operators, as on date. We have developed a platform called the 'Seat Seller' that allows agents to buy tickets from us on behalf of their customers. Also, we have around 100 partners, like travel websites, who build their own user interface on top of the Web services provided by Seat Seller."

Gidugu adds, "Apart from this, an important element of our business is the bus operator ecosystem. These operators also need software to run their operations, host their inventory, share their inventory with multiple travel sites and so on. For this, we have built software called BOSS, which stands for 'Bus Operators Software System' – a hosted ERP-cum-inventory management solution. A good number of operators that we work with today use BOSS to run their operations. With redBus.in, Seat Seller and BOSS, we cater to all the constituents of the bus industry."

Most of redBus' business runs on OSS

Gidugu considers Linux as the backbone of his business. The transaction software and financial software used by redBus are entirely based on Java. He says, "Spring and Hibernate are the technologies that we use. These systems are built on the Java stack because Java has proven credibility in building high-class enterprise products." The two software that have helped redBus grow are BOSS and Seat Seller, and both of them are based on OSS. Gidugu explains, "We rely on open source technology extensively to run our business smoothly. BOSS and Seat Seller are completely built on Java, and so are our backend transaction systems and those that interact with our financials."

We deploy these solutions on Ubuntu machines on Amazon Cloud. That's where the biggest use of open source comes in. We also use Pentaho, a business intelligence platform, for our internal business analytics."

Gidugu adds, "Google BigQuery is a Web service that lets you do interactive analysis of massive datasets—up to billions of rows. Though Google BigQuery is a priced